MIL-C-37117A (DM)
7 November 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-37117
12 May 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CASE, EAR PLUG

This specification is approved for use within DPSC, Defense Logistics Agency and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a personal, plastic, cylindrical container to store ear plugs when not in use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards and drawing. The following specifications, standards and drawing form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein unless otherwise specified, the issue of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

FF-R-556	Rivet, Solid, Small Rivets, Tubular, Small, and Caps, Rivets, General Purpose.
GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
RR-C-271	Chains and Attachments, Welded, Weldless, and Roller Chains.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Set-up.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of the document or by letter.

FSC 6515

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AMSC N/A

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STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-406	Plastic, Methods of Testing.
FED-STD-595A	Colors.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

No. 2153	CASE, EAR PLUG

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawing required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Case. The case (container) shall be molded from cellulose ester, other than butyrates, plastic conforming to the physical requirements specified herein. The plastic shall be colored and translucent as indicated in 3.3.

3.1.2 Bead chain. The bead chain shall be in accordance with RR-C-271, type II, class 5, 1/8-inch bead chain diameter, fabricated of brass, and having a blackened finish.

3.1.3 Bead chain fasteners. The bead chain fasteners shall be in accordance with attachment Type IX of RR-C-271, fabricated of brass, and having a blackened finish. The attachment shall be of an appropriate size for the chain specified in 3.1.2.

3.1.4 Rivets. The rivets shall be in accordance with FF-R-556, type XII, class 3, grade F, size 1/8-inch rivets and shall have a black oxidized finish.

3.1.5 Rivet burrs. The rivet burrs shall be fabricated of brass as required for the rivets and shall have a black oxidized finish. The rivet burrs shall be of appropriate size for the rivet specified in 3.1.4.

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3.2 Physical requirements of the case. The plastic portions of the cases or test coupons (specimens) when tested as specified in 4.4.1, shall conform to the following physical requirements:

	Minimum	Maximum
Tensile strength (pounds per square inch)	4700	--
Elongation (percent)	39	--
Impact strength (Izod - foot pounds per inch of notch)	1.9	--
Water absorption (percent)	--	2.3
Distortion under heat (temperature, ^{0}F.)	128	--
Flammability (inches per minute)	--	2.0
Accelerated aging (weight loss, percent)	--	3.6
Hardness (Rockwell R)	85	--

3.3 Construction and design. The case design shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center, (DPSC) Drawing 2153. Bead chain shall be fitted to the case and cap. Mold flash or sprues shall be removed from the finished case. Exposed surfaces of the finished case shall be smooth and shall exhibit as good an appearance as is consistent with the material molded. The cases shall approximate Fed. Std. 595A color 34259 or 34552. In addition, the cases shall be translucent so that the ear plugs to be contained therein are visible.

3.4 Workmanship. The finished case shall conform to the highest standards of commercial molding practice. The case shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or may impair its serviceability, shall be free from objectionable odor at the time of delivery, and shall not develop such odor during use and storage. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the acceptance criteria established herein.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, and auditory, investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The Certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sample specimens (coupons) for determining physical requirements of cases. Sample specimens (coupons) for determining compliance of cases with tests shall be prepared from sheets of material prepared from the same batch of plastic used in the manufacture of the cases under test.

4.2.2 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one case.

Table I. Sampling for Examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-2	1.5
Minor	S-1	1.5

4.2.3 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table II.

Table II. Sampling for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Req't	Test Procedure	Insp. level	AQL (percent defective)
Plastic	Physicals	3.2	4.4.1	S-1	1.5

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4.2.4 Sample unit usage. Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Examination of ear plug case. The cases shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification and drawing. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any cases in the lot containing one or more defects shall be rejected, if the number of defective cases exceeds the acceptance number for that sample.

Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Case not translucent; case not OD as specified.
102	Surfaces not uniform.
103	Screw cap difficult to apply or remove.
104	Case not in accordance with dimensions and construction specified.
Minor	
201	Not free of objectionable odor.
202	Presence of pits or surface irregularities more than 0.015 inch deep or high.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Tests for physical properties. The coupons (as specified in 4.2.1) shall be tested for compliance with the physical requirements specified in 3.2, in accordance with the appropriate test method of Federal Tests Method Standard No. 406.

	Method
Tensile strength	1011
Elongation	1011
Impact strength (Izod)	1071
Water absorption	7031
Distortion under heat	2011
Flammability	2021
Accelerated aging	6011 (Procedure I)
Hardness	1081

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4.5 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Twelve ear plug cases shall be clean and packaged in a snug fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. The level C preservation for ear plug cases shall conform to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Forty-eight unit packages (576 cases) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Forty-eight unit packages (576 cases) shall be packed in a exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The level C packing for ear plug cases shall conform to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.2.5 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be used whenever total quantities for shipment to one destination equal 40 cubic feet or more. Loads shall be unitized on pallets. Quantities less than 40 cubic feet need not be unitized. Unitized loads shall be uniform in size and quantities to the greatest extent practicable.

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5.2.5.1 Level A and B. Ear plug cases packed as specified in 5.2.1 and 5.2.2 shall be unitized on pallets conforming to MIL-STD-147.

5.2.5.2 Level C. Ear plug cases packed as specified in 5.2.3 shall be unitized as specified in MIL-STD-794.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Levels A, B, and C. Each unit pack, intermediate pack, exterior container and unitized load shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

5.4 General.

5.4.1 Exterior container. Exterior container (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, and 5.2.3) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.5.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. This ear plug case is intended to be used for storing one pair of ear plugs.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) National Stock Number (NSN).
(c) Selection of applicable level of packing and packaging (see 5.1 and 5.2)

6.3 This specification covers the following National Stock Number:

NSN	Item Identification
6515-01-212-9452	CASE, EAR PLUG, CYLINDRICAL, Olive Drab, 12s

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
DoD-MB

Agent:
DLA-DM

Project No: 6515-3469

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

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1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-37117A	

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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